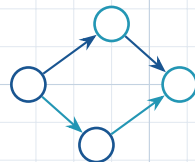


Forensics for Cybercrimes Committed Using Artificial Intelligence

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2026



The Emerging Problem

Artificial intelligence is increasingly being used to:

- automate cyberattacks;
- generate deceptive digital content;
- impersonate individuals and organisations;
- manipulate digital evidence;
- scale traditional cybercrime.

Artificial Intelligence



Cybercrime



Digital Evidence

Traditional digital forensics

- Identify the device
- Acquire the evidence
- Preserve integrity
- Analyse artefacts
- Establish attribution

AI-enabled cybercrime

- Synthetic identities
- AI-generated content
- Automated attacks
- Adversarial manipulation
- Difficult attribution

Research Question

How can digital forensic methods reliably identify, preserve, analyse and attribute evidence arising from cybercrimes committed using artificial intelligence?

Formalising Digital Evidence

Let the set of digital evidence be represented by

$$E = \{e_1, e_2, \dots, e_n\}$$

where each element represents a digital artefact.

For example:

$$E = \{\text{email, metadata, log, image, network packet}\}$$

We can define a forensic evidence function:

$$F(e_i) = \{A_i, I_i, P_i, T_i\}$$

where:

- A_i = authenticity
- I_i = integrity
- P_i = provenance

Evidence Relationships

Digital evidence does not exist in isolation.

Consider:

$$G = (V, E)$$

where:

- V represents digital entities;
- E represents relationships between entities.

Examples of nodes:

$$V = \{\text{user, device, account, IP, email}\}$$

Examples of edges:

$$E = \{\text{login, communication, transfer, execution}\}$$

Digital Forensic Evidence Pipeline



- ❶ **Collection** — acquire relevant digital artefacts.
- ❷ **Preservation** — protect integrity and provenance.
- ❸ **Analysis** — reconstruct events and relationships.
- ❹ **Presentation** — communicate findings for decision-making.

Research Objectives

- ➊ Examine existing digital forensic approaches for AI-enabled cybercrime.
- ➋ Identify forensic challenges introduced by artificial intelligence.
- ➌ Develop a framework for collection, preservation, analysis and presentation of AI-related digital evidence.
- ➍ Investigate methods for authenticity, provenance and attribution.
- ➎ Validate the proposed framework using appropriate forensic scenarios and datasets.

Expected Contribution

Theoretical

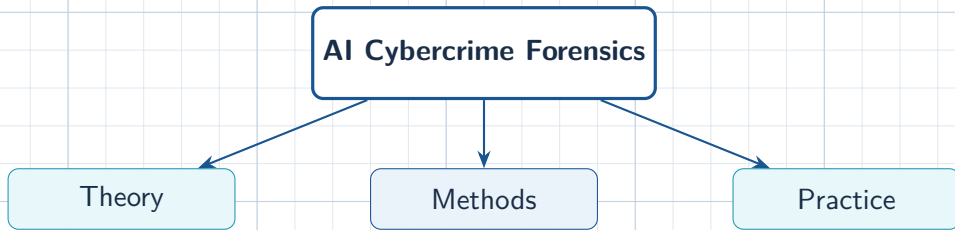
Formalisation of forensic reasoning for AI-enabled cybercrime.

Technical

Methods for analysing authenticity, provenance and attribution.

Practical

A forensic framework applicable to real-world investigations.



Why This Matters

The central argument

As cybercrime evolves from human-operated attacks toward AI-assisted and AI-generated attacks, forensic science must also evolve.

AI-enabled crime $\Rightarrow$ AI-aware forensic reasoning

The research therefore seeks to bridge:

Artificial Intelligence $\leftrightarrow$ **Cybersecurity** $\leftrightarrow$ **Digital Forensics**

Conclusion

- AI is changing the nature and scale of cybercrime.
- Digital evidence associated with AI-enabled crime requires stronger methods of authentication and attribution.
- Formal reasoning, graph analysis and forensic methodologies can complement conventional investigations.
- The proposed research aims to develop a defensible framework for AI-enabled cybercrime forensics.

From digital artefacts to defensible forensic conclusions

Thank You

Questions and Discussion

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